Conference or Training Request Approval Template
Attendance

Date 2026-10-24

Basic Information:

Agency: Rural Development (RD)

Program Area: Centralized Training (TO VERIFY program area)

Accounting Data: TO VERIFY (Register R-05)

Project code: TO VERIFY (Register R-05)

Event Name: USDA RD Centralized Training

Event Date(s): 2026-11-29 thru 2026-12-01 Event Location: Boston, MA (TO VERIFY venue, R-01)

Primary POC: Conference Coordinator, USDA RD (TO VERIFY name/phone/email)
Name, Phone, email

Secondary POC: TO VERIFY name/phone/email
Name, Phone, email

Estimated Expense Total: $34,242.77 (base $32,612

Select One: Conference ☐ Training ☑

If the event is training, is it considered Continuing Professional Education? Yes ☐ No ☐

Recurring Event: Yes ☐ No ☐ If yes, select ☐ Annual or ☐ Biennial ☐

Provide actual expense information for previous year(s) participation in this event.

Annual TO VERIFY (R Biennial TO VERIFY (R

Narrative fields are limited to 8-10 lines of data using Times New Roman 10-pitch. Information beyond the visible field will not be viewed or printed

Event Purpose: (Narrative description of the Conference or Training objectives and expected outcomes.)

Centralized in-person training for 24 RD staff (DC-based), Nov 29-Dec 1 2026 in Boston, MA. Objective: deliver skills/updates requiring hands-on, instructor-led format. Expected outcome: consistent procedural competency across participants. Site selected by cost/compliance screen of 5 candidate cities (real airfare + >=2 hotel quotes each, GSA per-diem compliant). Full cost basis & sources in conference_budget.xlsx; open conditions in approval_register.csv. Specific agenda/objectives TO VERIFY.

Was event included on the current year conference plan? Yes ☐ No ☐

If no, why was the event omitted ?

TO VERIFY - current-year conference-plan inclusion not yet confirmed (Register R-12). If omitted, rationale to be documented by Program Office before approval.

How will the event help further the Agency's mission or the Department's strategic plan? (Narrative justification)

Supports RD mission by equipping staff to administer rural programs consistently and in compliance with Federal Travel/Acquisition regulations. Specific strategic-plan linkage TO VERIFY with Program Office.

The number of employees attending is appropriate to the purpose of the event and the mission of the agency. (Narrative justification)

Headcount of 24 reflects the operating group requiring the training; the costed option fits the $53,000 ceiling with ~$18.8k headroom. Minimum-necessary justification & final roster TO VERIFY (Register R-04, 41 CFR 301-74.13).

The event is a "must-do" considering the limited budget of the agency. The information cannot be effectively shared through another means such as a teleconference, video conferencing, webinars, or other alternative media tools. (Narrative justification)

In-person format chosen where hands-on/instructor-led delivery is required; alternatives (teleconference/webinar) narrative justification TO VERIFY with Sponsoring Program Official before approval.

Federal funds will only be used for necessary and appropriate purposes and all conference expenses and activities will comply with the Federal Travel Regulation (FTR), the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR), the Agricultural Travel Regulation, and any other USDA requirements on lodging, food and beverages, per diem reimbursement, and contracting of goods and services.

Yes ☑ No ☐

Attendee Information:

Total Attendees: 24

Sponsoring Agency Attendees/Participants: 24 (Rura

Other USDA Attendees/Participants: 0

Other Federal Attendees/Participants: 0

Non-Federal Attendees/Participants: 0

Will contributions be accepted from non-federal sources to defray the cost of attending the conference?

☐ Yes ☑ No

If Yes, then how much will be accepted? N/A - none ass

If contributions will be accepted, has the acceptance decision been discussed with the Office of General Counsel? If yes, then ***please provide a copy of the OGC opinion.***

☐ Yes ☐ No

Will your agency be hosting a booth (USDA or otherwise) at the event?

☐ Yes ☐ No

Attachments:

1. ☐ Draft or previous year event agenda *(with specific information on how meals will be handled)*
2. ☐ Location Cost Estimate *(properly completed)*
3. ☐ Attendee Cost Detail spreadsheet *(excel soft copy version)*

Reportable (check all that apply):

☑ USDA OCFO [*over $7,000*]

☐ USDA OIG [*over $20,000]*

☐ HR933, Section 3003 [*over $100,000*]